

Built to Keep You Scrolling



BIG IDEA Apps are designed by people to keep your attention. When you can spot the design tricks, you can choose your own limits on purpose, without shame.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R10 mock feed screens (ScrollSpot is fictional) per pair, Design Feature Cards per group, Workbook CF-10 and My Limits plan, My Help Ladder card (final version).

- ☐ Copy R10 screens per pair; one Design Feature set per group.
- ☐ Find students' My Help Ladder cards from Lesson 1.
- ☐ Know your counselor and 988 (call or text).

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script *Hackles up? Notice how an app makes you feel when you want to stop and it will not let you. It is never your fault.* “Quick check, no talking. Have you ever opened an app for a minute and looked up half an hour later? That is no personal failure. Many apps are built by teams whose job is to keep your attention. That is persuasive design. Today you are a design detective. Screens are not bad. You should be the one choosing. And if you ever feel hopeless or stuck, talk to a trusted adult. This lesson is about choices, with no shame.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Design Detective*

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-10.** Eli, twelve, has a streak with a friend. His phone buzzes: “Do not lose your streak!” The feed never ends. One late night he cannot stop and wonders if something is wrong with him. Nothing is wrong with Eli. The app was designed to make stopping hard.
- 2 (4 min) Design Detective in pairs.** Circle each feature on the ScrollSpot screens and match it to a card: endless scroll, autoplay, streaks, notifications and badges, like counts, variable rewards. Write what it wants me to do and one way to take back control.
- 3 (2 min) My Limits plan.** Two changes (a notification off, a device bedtime, a time limit) and one replacement habit.
- 4 (1 min) Update the My Help Ladder card** with names and roles, including 988 and text HOME to 741741.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which design feature is hardest to resist? Why was it designed that way?”
- 2** “What is the difference between choosing an app and being pulled by one?”
- 3** “How do you know when screen time is hurting your sleep, mood or friendships? Who could you talk to?”

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause when you notice you are scrolling on autopilot. Check which design feature is pulling you. Tell a trusted adult if screen time is making you feel worse. It is never your fault if apps are hard to put down. You can still choose.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: “It was built to be hard to stop. You still get to choose.”

EXIT TICKET “Write one limit you chose and one person you could ask for help sticking to it.”

FUN BOOST Redesign Sprint. Pairs get 3 minutes to redesign one ScrollSpot feature so it is easier to put down (a stopping point, a “you are caught up” message). Gallery vote.

LEVEL-UP Seven-Day Experiment. Try one limit for a week and note how sleep and mood felt. Private.

DIFFERENTIATE Give a labeled screen with features pre-circled and a menu of limits.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Which app is hardest for you to put down? What limit could we try together?” If your child seems low, the counselor can help; 988 is available by call or text.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble.”
- “This is not your fault.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “You are addicted” or “Just put the phone down.”
- “Everyone feels like that.”
- “I won’t tell anyone.” Do not diagnose.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: any hint of self-harm or hopelessness: stay with the student, follow your district protocol, call or text 988. Tell your counselor or designated person; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.